



TROOPOOL

The network is the product.

A verified networking platform for professionals who happen to commute together. The commute is the reason to meet - meet people on your route, swipe to connect, carpool, build circles. LinkedIn x sRide, not Uber x sRide.

Business case study - product (v4) - market & monetization - India-first, 2026

01

The problem

Indian commutes are long, costly and lonely - and hybrid work removed the office as the professional/social layer.

THE PROBLEM

A double pain: cost and isolation

**Rs 200-
300**

spent per day on cab
commutes

44%

drive private cars - empty
seats

35%

of urban adults chronically
lonely

+28%

YoY friendship-app
downloads

Sources: Statista 2024, Market Research Future, loneliness-economy reports. [C]/[E]

The white space nobody owns

- **Carpool apps (sRide, Quick Ride, Scoop)**

Utility, no network - you book a seat, then nothing brings you back. (Scoop users met cross-department colleagues - but it never built the network layer.)

- **Social apps (Bumble BFF, Meetup, Nextdoor)**

Citywide strangers - no commute context, no real-orbit trust.

- **Troopool = verified real-orbit + swipe-to-match + B2B distribution**

The professional-networking engine no one owns. Carpool is the wedge; the network is the product.

02

The reposition

Troopool is NOT a carpool app. It is a networking platform for professionals who happen to commute together.

The winning loop

- **Route match -> Swipe -> Match -> Chat**

Meet people in your orbit and connect on a mutual like - the sRide-iOS Meet People mechanic.

- **Carpool -> Friendship -> Circle -> Community**

The commute creates the first interaction; networking creates retention; community creates daily engagement.

- **First screen is People in your orbit - never Find a ride**

Carpool is the daily habit. The network is the point.

How it works

- **1 - Build your Trust Score**
Phone + work email required; DigiLocker / selfie optional, each raising a visible 0-100 score. No LinkedIn.
- **2 - Network - swipe to connect**
Tinder-style deck of people on your route / nearby / interests. Pass or connect; mutual -> match -> chat.
- **3 - Do something real**
Chat chips: Coffee, Carpool, Walk, Event, Circle. Carpool a match -> host accepts -> ride group chat.
- **4 - Community & daily engagement**
Pro circles with events & polls; Home dashboard + smart notifications; people-you-may-know after 3 connects.

03

Goal & market

Save money and build a real professional network on the daily commute - for employees and the companies that employ them.

GOAL

Goal & success metric



Goal

Turn the daily commute into a professional network - meet, carpool, join circles. For companies: engagement, retention, parking relief and BRSR Scope-3 reporting.



Success

A verified professional who, within 2 weeks, has made real connections (matches), carpooled once, and joined a circle - and keeps opening the app daily.

Primary market & personas

Primary market

- Verified corporate professionals, Indian IT corridors
- 25-40 - Infosys / TCS / Wipro / Cognizant campuses
- Pune, Bengaluru, Hyderabad, Mumbai, Delhi-NCR
- Dense corridors + employer rollout = solves cold-start
- B2B buyer: HR / facilities / sustainability

Personas

- Aisha, 26 - new to city: meet people fast + save
- Rahul, 31 - hybrid: fuel savings + wider network
- Ankit, 29 - wants founders & AI peers (circles)
- Priya, 34 - safety-first: high-trust matches
- Sahil - HR/ESG: engagement + ESG dashboard

Market size & growth

**Rs
88.3M+**

India carpooling 2024 -
7.8% CAGR

**Rs 282M-
1.32B**

India friendship/dating by
2035 - 15% CAGR

**~Rs 280-
370B**

carpool TAM (urban India,
annual)

**Rs 420-
500M**

realistic Year-1 SOM via
B2B anchor

TAM/SAM/SOM from BUSINESS-ANALYSIS.md. [C] market figures, [E] SOM model.

COMPETITION

Competitive landscape

Player	Scale	Model	Gap Troopool fills
sRide	3M+ - 400+ corps	subscription + B2B	No network / community layer
Quick Ride	\$15.8M raised	commission	No network layer
Scoop (US)	acq. 2024 (Spacer)	employer-paid TDM	Single-mode; no community; folded
BlaBlaCar	EUR 253M - 92M pax	10-12% commission	Long-distance DNA
Bumble BFF / Meetup	200M / 60M	subscription / events	No commute - low India ARPU

Positioning - a quadrant no one owns

- **High network value x verified marketplace x B2B distribution**

sRide/Quick Ride/Scoop = transport utility, low social. Bumble/Meetup = social, no commute or India monetization.

- **Troopool = the upper-right**

Professional networking on a verified daily orbit, distributed through corporates - defensible by real-orbit trust and repeated proximity.

04

Business & monetization

Carpool is the wedge; B2B SaaS + ride commission are the money. No consumer paywall.

How it makes money

- **1 - Consumer ride commission - 6-8% on the cost-share**
Rs 5-10 on a Rs 70-100 carpool. Cost-sharing-compliant, far below Uber's 25-30%.
- **2 - B2B SaaS (flagship) - Rs 30-50 / employee / month**
Networking + ride matching + HR portal + BRSR Scope-3 carbon & engagement dashboard. 70-80% gross margin.
- **3 - Community experiences**
Ticketed circle events & partner perks. No consumer subscription - the network stays free to grow.

The B2B / ESG engine - why companies pay

Scope-3

BRSR commuting
disclosure - top-1,000
listed

~22%

corporate transport cost
cut

8.4/10

employee engagement
score (in-app)

~70%

retention uplift (Zeelo)

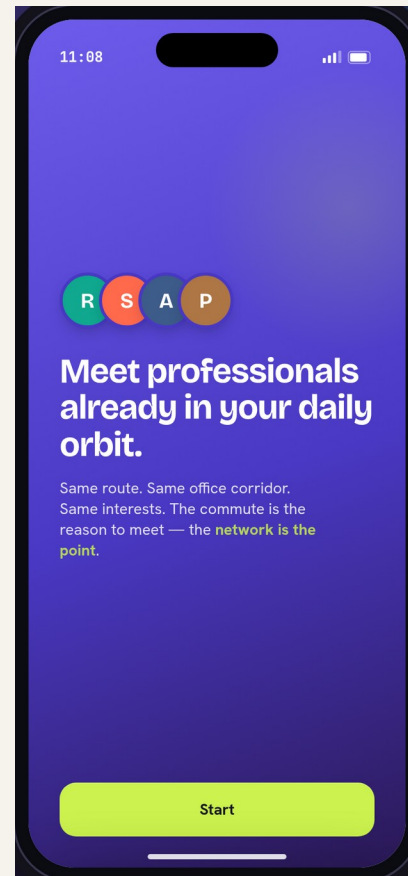
Sources: SEBI BRSR, Zeelo, GHG Protocol Ch.7. [C]/[E]

05

Product walkthrough

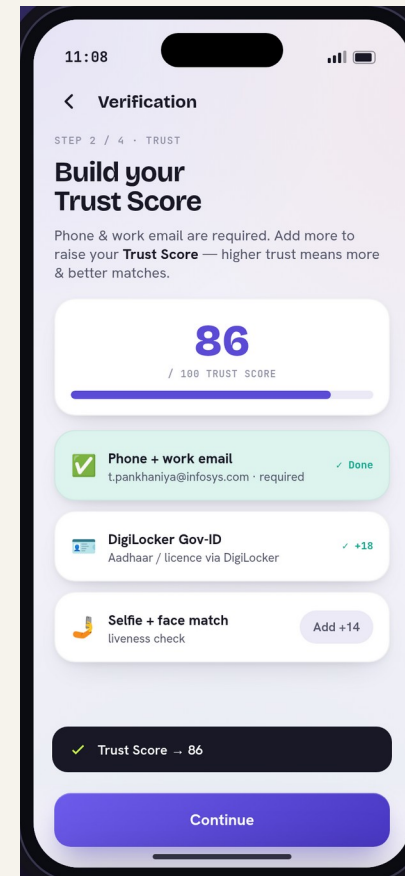
Start to finish on the live prototype ([troopool-v4.html](#)) - people first, swipe to connect.

Onboard & build trust



Welcome

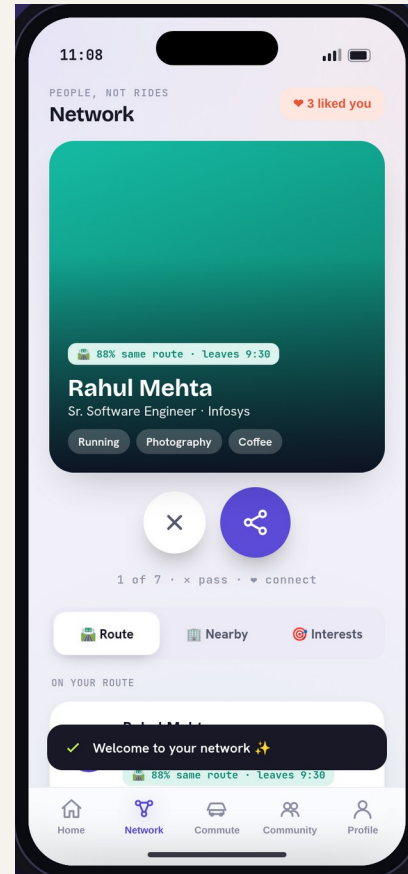
Meet professionals already in your daily orbit.



Build your Trust Score

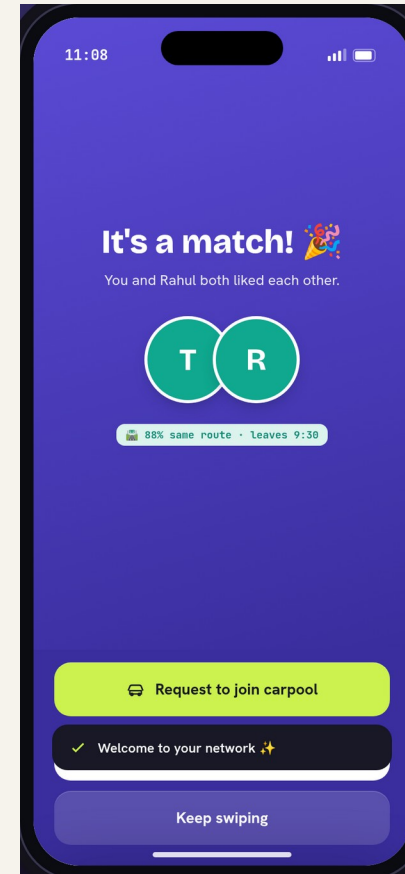
Phone + email required; DigiLocker / selfie raise a 0-100 score.

Connect by swiping (sRide-style)



Network - people, not rides

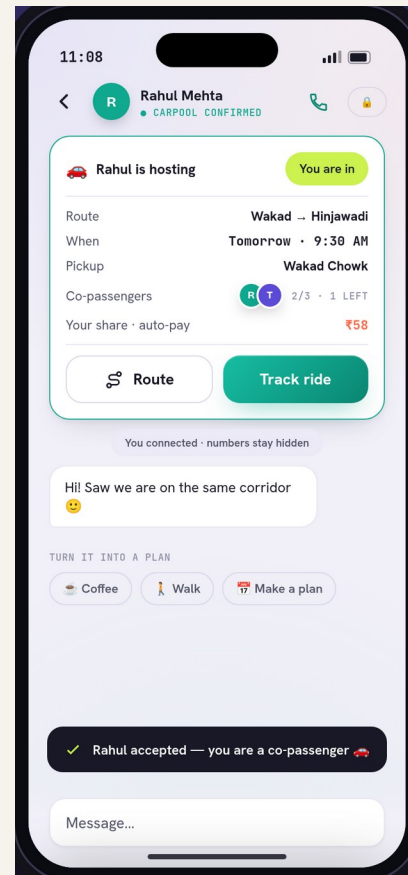
Swipe pass / connect through your orbit.



It's a match!

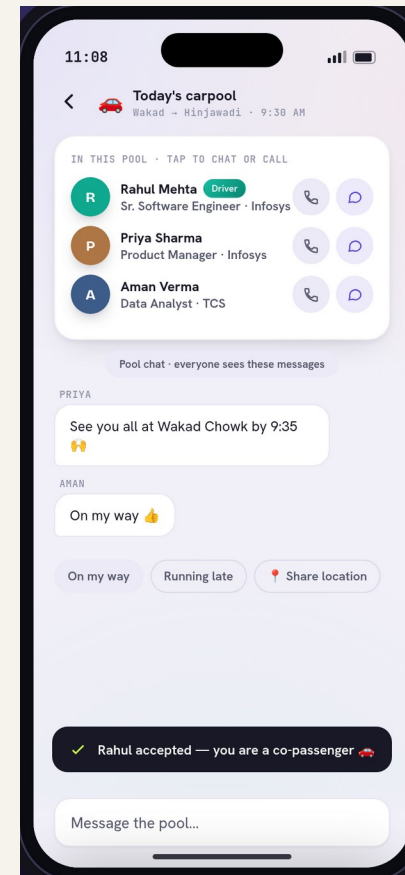
A mutual like opens a chat - no connect-request.

Carpool - the reason to meet



Carpool a match

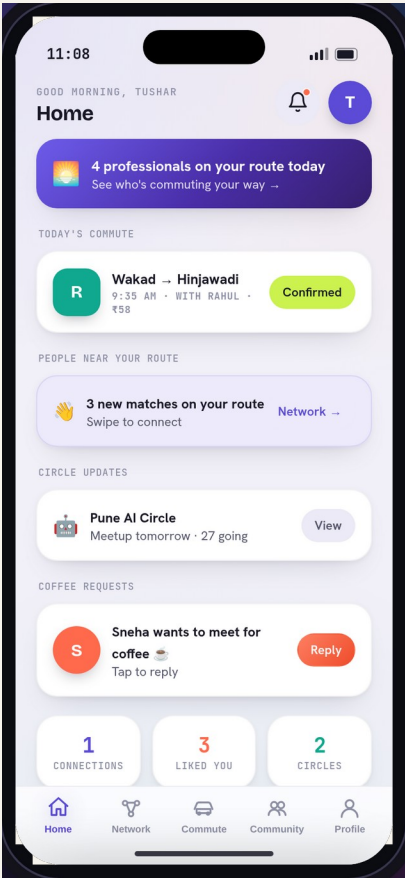
Request -> host accepts -> confirmed pool, scoped to the chat.



Ride group chat

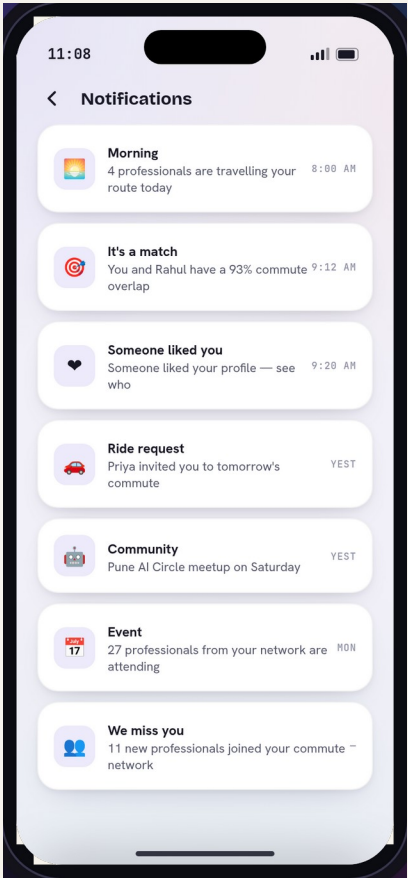
Driver + all co-passengers connect - networking, not just a ride.

Daily engagement



Home dashboard

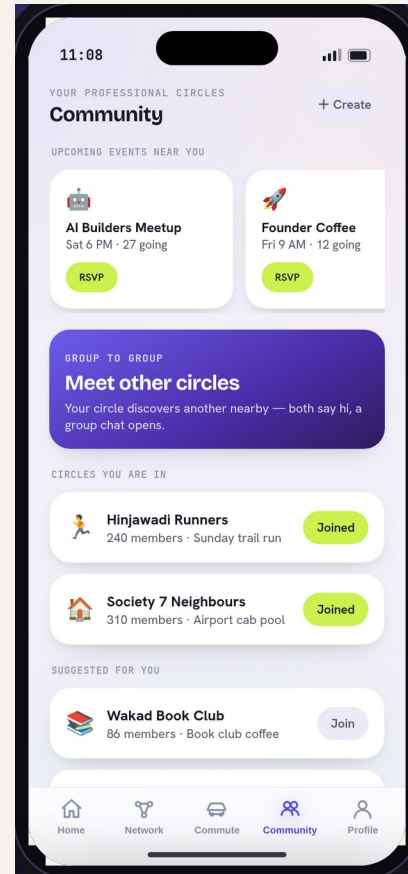
Today's commute, new matches, circle updates, coffee requests.



Smart notifications

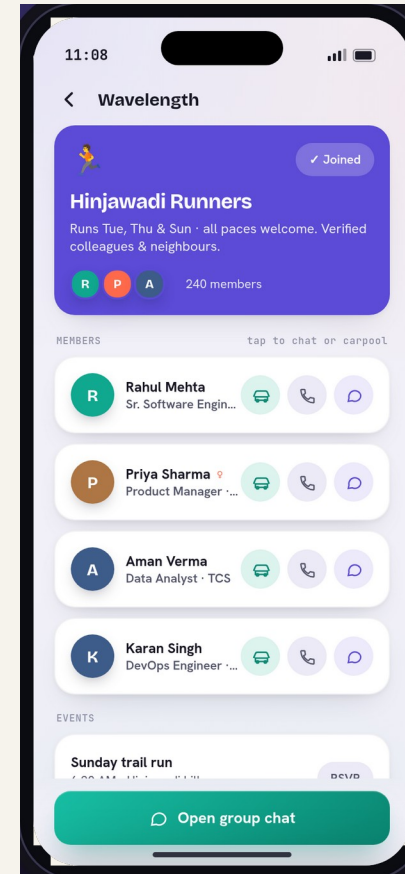
Morning, match, ride, event - categorized, never spam.

Community



Professional circles + events

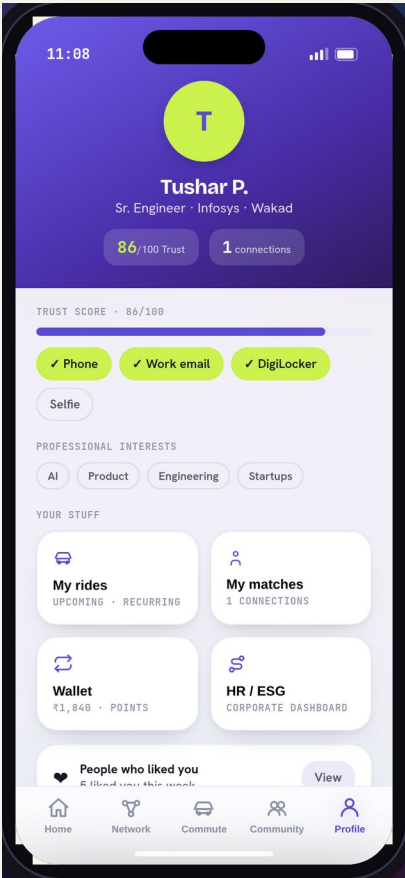
RSVP events, vote polls, post carpool requests.



Inside a circle

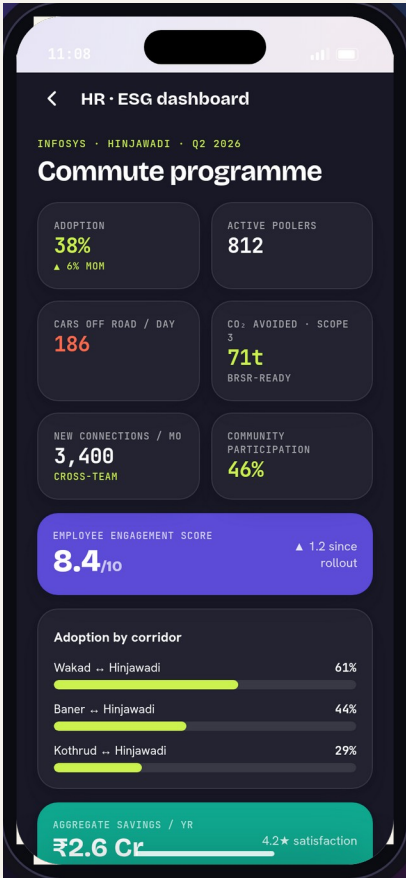
Members you chat / call / carpool - events - polls.

Trust & the B2B story



Profile + Trust Score

Verification badges, professional interests, connections.



HR / ESG dashboard

Adoption - new connections - engagement 8.4/10 - CO2 Scope-3.

The user story

What the user wants

- See people in my orbit, not a ride search
- Swipe & connect on a mutual like (sRide-style)
- A Trust Score that gets me better matches
- Turn a match into a carpool / coffee / circle
- A ride group where co-passengers all connect
- A reason to open the app daily - no spam

The journeys

- A - Trust -> swipe -> match -> chat -> carpool -> rate
- B - Join a circle -> RSVP event -> vote poll -> meet circles
- C - Home -> morning route -> matches -> circle updates
- D - HR -> adoption - connections - engagement - CO2

06

Go-to-market, economics & roadmap

Anchor on corporates in the Maharashtra legal window; the network drives retention carpool can't.

Cold-start - the B2B anchor (Scoop/Karos playbook)

■ Phase 0 - 0-3 mo

5-10 marquee campuses (Bengaluru + Mumbai). Employer subsidises fares; 80% match-rate by week 2; guaranteed-ride-home.

■ Phase 1 - 3-6 mo

Swipe network + referrals (k 1.2-1.4). HR champions. 100-200K users.

■ Phase 2 - 6-12 mo

Hyderabad + Delhi. Circle events. 200-400K users - Rs 420-500M run-rate.

Unit economics & KPIs (Year-1 targets)

75-80%

ride match rate

40-45%

D30 retention (network-boosted)

3:1 - 5:1

LTV : CAC

70-80%

B2B SaaS gross margin

Benchmarks vs BlaBlaCar Daily, NFX cold-start, SaaS standards. [C]/[E]

3-year financial outline

	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3
Cities	4	8	12-15
MAU	0.2-0.4M	1-1.5M	3-5M
B2B clients	50-100	200-400	800-1,200
ARR	Rs 420-500M	Rs 2.5-3.5B	Rs 8-10B

Risks & mitigation

- **Regulation (top risk)**
Launch Maharashtra (legal Apr 2025); corporate-transport framing; Delhi deferred.
- **Safety / women-safety**
Trust Score + KYC, women-only mode, SOS, live tracking, 2-way ratings.
- **Cold-start liquidity**
B2B anchor; subsidised drivers M1-3; guaranteed-ride-home; 80% match-rate.
- **Single-mode fragility (Scoop's lesson)**
Network + community + multi-modal so value survives when carpool dips.

People first. Rides second. **The network is the product.**

Verified real-orbit + swipe-to-match + B2B/ESG distribution - the engagement engine carpool apps can't build.

Troopool - meet the people on your way.